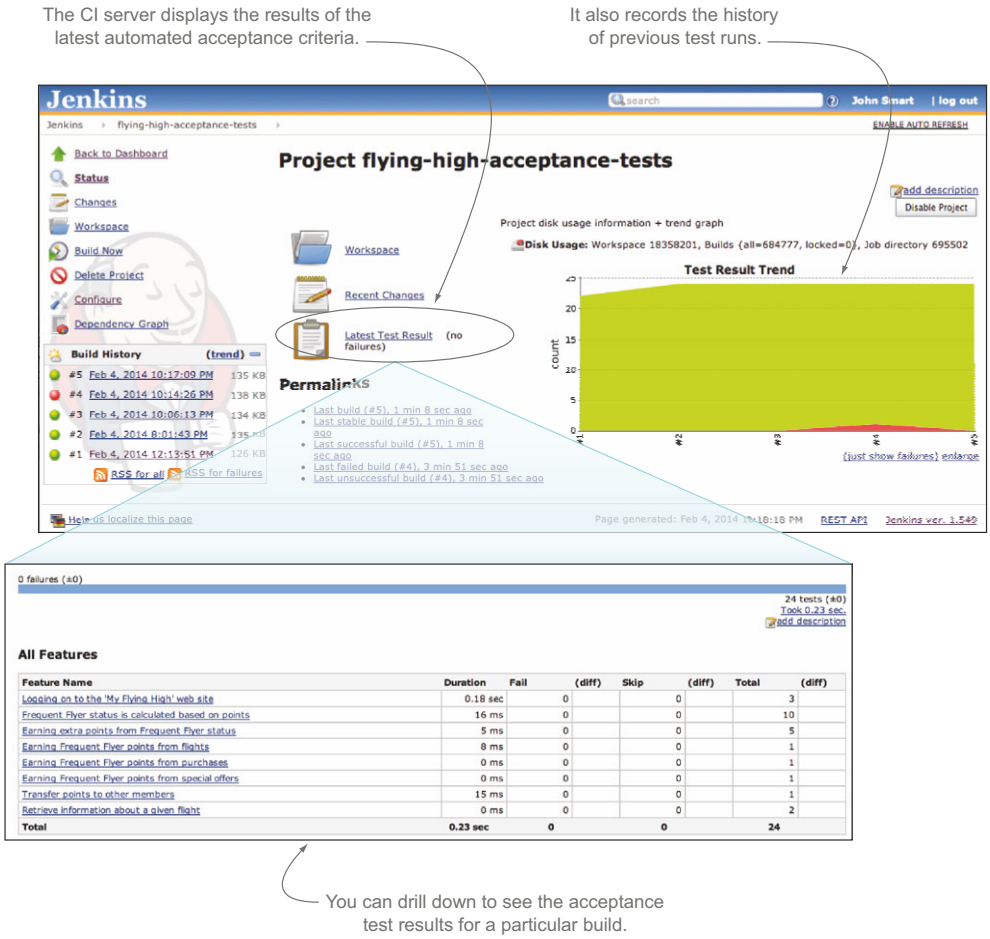


Figure 12.4 Automated acceptance criteria are typically run on a CI server, such as Jenkins.

CI relies heavily on good automated testing: without automated testing, a CI server is little better than an automated compilation checker. But with reliable and comprehensive automated tests, the team can use the CI build results to evaluate the current state of the application. If every feature has a meaningful set of automated unit and acceptance tests, then the automated test reports will give a meaningful picture of the current state of the application.

For teams practicing BDD, a CI server also acts as a platform for automatically building and publishing living documentation. The full set of automated acceptance criteria is executed for each change made to the application. Issues are raised quickly, but even when all goes well, the living documentation generated from the acceptance criteria is updated and published for each change to the application. This provides much faster feedback for business analysts, testers, and even business stakeholders about the current state of the application. They don't have to wait for the developers